Michael Despres

PLATFORM PRODUCT MANAGEMENT · REVENUE OPERATIONS · SYSTEMS & AI AUTOMATION

Tampa Bay, FL · michael.despres@gmail.com · linkedin.com/in/michaelrdespres · mdespres84.github.io

SUMMARY

Platform product manager and revenue operations leader with nine years building the sales systems behind a global B2B SaaS company. Designed the territory, role, and routing structure an international sales org across ten markets still runs on. Known for turning manual, error-prone processes into governed, automated systems, and for being the person senior sales leaders call when something breaks.

EXPERIENCE

KnowBe4, Inc. — Clearwater, FL

2017 – Present

Global security awareness SaaS company (Nasdaq: KNBE; taken private by Vista Equity Partners in 2023). Created the Division / Region / Territory taxonomy international sales still runs on.

Platform Product Manager

2026 – Present

- **Directed the knowledge handoff to Business Operations** as Revenue Systems Operations moved into platform product roles
- **Led the Crossbeam partner-data integration** and access rollout for channel and alliances teams, and wrote the documentation the process team adopted into its company-wide library
- **Built a Claude-based reassignment tool** now used by the business applications team for book-of-business handoffs
- **Audited permissions across the sales engineering team** and published a how-to plus an AI instruction guide

International Sales Operations Analyst

2020 – 2026

- **Built the structure behind international expansion**, owning territory sizing, headcount analysis, and role hierarchy design across Brazil, LATAM, UK&I, Europe, DACH, South Africa, the Middle East, Japan, Singapore, and Australia
- **Cut rep-transition time from 6 hours to under 30 minutes** by building a custom AI skill on top of the reassignment method designed for departures, promotions, and territory rebalances
- **Reversed an unsupported territory decision** with lead, task, and closed-revenue analysis that leadership acted on
- **Owned Salesforce change management** for the international business: documented CAB review and a Dev → QA → Staging → Production pipeline in Copado and Jira
- **Delivered on major launches,** including the GTM redesign migration weekend and the merge of customer and prospect data into a single Salesforce instance
- **Trusted advisor to EVP- and VP-level sales and channel leaders.** Designed discount-approval routing (Director → CRO) for every region and kept the international case queue at zero backlog

Operations Financial Systems Administrator

2017 – 2019

- **Built the company-wide BI platform** in Klipfolio: 150+ components and 30+ dashboards on a Salesforce data integration, giving leaders across five business segments the real-time data behind their coaching and pipeline reviews
- **Led UAT for the Salesforce CPQ launch** and the Avalara AvaTax multi-jurisdiction sales tax integration, including post-Wayfair economic nexus rules
- Managed 35,000+ general ledger lines

Sales Representative

2017

- Met or exceeded goals; promoted into operations after six months

Earlier: VP Operations, Momentum Capital Consulting (2016–17), built the firm's Google Workspace for contract and client data, with mail-merge contract distribution · Account Executive, PLS Logistics (2014–15), team of 6, $90–130K a month in freight · Office Manager, Universal Air and Heat (2013–14), 15-person sales and install team · Chief Safety Officer, MetroRock Newburyport

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

B.A. Economics, University of South Florida (2016) · Lean Six Sigma Black Belt (SSGI) · Agile Leadership (SSGI)

TOOLS & RECOGNITION

Tools: Salesforce (Admin, SOQL, CPQ, release management) · Copado · Jira · Crossbeam · Klipfolio · Avalara AvaTax · Excel · Python · Claude / AI workflow automation

Recognition: LinkedIn recommendations from senior executives (linkedin.com/in/michaelrdespres), plus 65 written recognitions from 40+ colleagues across six sales regions (2018–2026).